

Cubism

One of the most influential art movements, Cubism was invented in 1907–08 when Picasso and Georges Braque (1882–1963) broke with the European traditions of creating illusions of space from fixed viewpoints. Other Cubists included Albert Gleizes (1881–1953), Jean Metzinger (1883–1956), Henri Le Fauconnier (1881–1946), Fernand Léger (1881–1955) and Juan Gris (1887–1927). The movement began with Picasso's *Les Femmes d'Alger*, 1907, which showed Cézanne's influence, particularly his late works, as well as African masks and Spanish sculpture.

By painting objects from several viewpoints at once, the artists aimed to show three-dimensional forms on flat canvases, without attempting to create illusions of depth. The name Cubism derived from a comment by critic Louis Vauxcelles (1870–1943), though neither Braque nor Picasso used it. Analytical Cubism, consisting of planes and lines in blacks, greys and ochres, lasted from 1908 to 1912. Synthetic Cubism lasted from c.1912–14, and featured brighter colours and elements of collage.



Braque, *Houses at L'Estaque*, 1908